Agilent VWorks ActiveX Controls

Version 13.1.9

Release Notes

Agilent Technologies

Notices

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Software Revision

This guide is valid for Agilent VWorks ActiveX Controls Software Kit 13.1.9.

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Introduction

This document describes the functions, features and changes introduced with this release of the Agilent VWorks ActiveX Controls. References to product documentation regarding known issues and workarounds are also provided.

Supported Devices

The VWorks ActiveX Controls is a suite of software components that allows third-party lab automation software to integrate with the following Agilent devices:

- BenchCel Microplate Handler
- PlateLoc Thermal Microplate Sealer
- Labware MiniHub
- Microplate Centrifuge
- Microplate Centrifuge with Loader
- Microplate Labeler
- Labware Stacker

Device and Firmware Compatibility

Device	**Firmware Version**
BenchCel Microplate Handler	3.2.20
PlateLoc Thermal Microplate Sealer	3.9.0 and later
Agilent Labware MiniHub (model number G5584A)	4.0.56 and later (Controller Node), 4.129.2 (Master Node)
Agilent Labware MiniHub (model numbers: G5508-60010, G5508-60009, G5508-60031)	Not applicable
Microplate Centrifuge	2.3
Microplate Centrifuge with Loader	1.1.1
Microplate Labeler	2.4.4
Labware Stacker	1.7.2

Known Issues

Number	Summary
ACXSDK-69	Stacker ActiveX: Initialization with invalid profile name saves the invalid name in the profiles list. When ShowDiagnostics method is called, it will use this invalid profile. **Workaround**: Verify that the profile is valid before selecting it.
ACXSDK-68	Centrifuge ActiveX. If the Centrifuge is turned off or not connected and you attempt to initialize, duplicate “Could not connect” events are fired. **Workaround**: Make sure that proper connections are made and the instrument is powered on before attempting to initialize it.
ACXSDK-93	BenchCel ActiveX: ShowLabwareEditor opens the labware editor only as a modal dialog. **Workaround**: None
ACXSDK-64	Centrifuge ActiveX: A 2-minute delay occurs before the error message is displayed when trying to initialize the Centrifuge if the instrument power is turned off. **Workaround**: Ensure that the instrument is powered on before initializing it.
ACXSDK-63	Labware MiniHub ActiveX: If a connection failure occurs during the Initialize Method call, the system takes about 5 minutes to return control. **Workaround**: Ensure that the instrument is powered on before initializing it.
ACXSDK-73	Centrifuge ActiveX: From Centrifuge diagnostics, if the value for “time to spin” is specified as greater than 24 hours, then spin cycle won’t start and no error message will be displayed. **Workaround**: Make sure to specify “Time to Spin” value as less than 24 hours.
ACXSDK-71	BenchCel or Stacker ActiveX: Opening the Labware Editor from diagnostics of either BenchCel or ActiveX causes all non-current tabs to be grayed out, but they can still be selected. **Workaround:** None
ACXSDK-70	Labware MiniHub: You cannot retry or ignore the errors from GetCurrentCassette(), Jog(), RotateToDegree() methods. **Workaround**: None

Issues Addressed

Number	Summary
ACXSDK-84	Timeout error when communicating with Centrifuge. The Centrifuge plugin intermittently loses communication while opening/closing the door, locking/unlocking bucket or spinning. Happens once every 25 days running a realistic workflow.

Computer Requirements

If your organization uses a computer other than one configured by Agilent Technologies, make sure the computer meets the following minimum requirements:

- Computer
  - Windows 7 64-bit or Windows 10 64-bit operating system
  - 2 GHz or faster 64-bit processor, multicore preferred
  - 4 GB RAM
  - 40 GB hard drive capacity with 10 GB free space
  - 1280 x 1024 pixel screen resolution
  - One of the following browsers with JavaScript enabled (required for using the context-sensitive help and knowledge base)
    1. Microsoft Internet Explorer 11.0 or Microsoft Edge v25
  - A PDF viewer, such as Adobe Reader 10.0 (required for opening the user guide PDF files)
- Communications interface using one of the following:
  - Dedicated 10BaseT or faster Ethernet card if you are connecting via Ethernet (two network cards if connecting to your local area network)
  - RS-232 DB9 serial port, if you are connecting via serial

Installing VWorks ActiveX Controls

To install the software:

1. Insert the Agilent VWorks ActiveX Controls UFD into an available USB port and double-click VWorksActiveXControls 13.1.9.1493.exe.

   Follow the instructions that appear on the screen.

Where to Find User Guides

The user guides for Agilent Automation Solutions products are available in the following locations:

- *PDF files*. The PDF files of the user guides are installed with the VWorks ActiveX Controls software and are on the software CD that is supplied with the product. A PDF viewer is required to open a user guide in PDF format. You can download a free PDF viewer from the internet. For information about using PDF documents, see the user documentation for the PDF viewer.
- *Agilent Technologies website*. You can search the online VWorks Knowledge Base or download the latest version of any PDF file from the Agilent Automation Solutions pages at http://www.agilent.com/en-us/products/automation-solutions. You can also use the following link to access the knowledge base directly at http://www.agilent.com/chem/askb.